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THE DIGITAL WATCHDOG:

COLLABORATIVE ENFORCEMENT OF PUBLIC ACCOUNTABILITY WITH DATA SCIENCE AND AI

Presented by: Lanz Anthonee A. Lagman

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Fury over corruption and 'nepo babies' as floods paralyse Philippines

18 September 2025

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Joel Guinto, Singapore and Virma Simonette, Manila

CNN World

WORLD > ASIA • 7 MIN READ

The disaster-prone Philippines invested billions in flood control. Then officials looted the funds

By Lex Harvey

Nation

Sandiganbayan division officially declares Zaldy Co a 'fugitive'

Job Manahan, ABS-CBN News

Published Feb 11, 2026 07:43 PM PHT | Updated Feb 11, 2026 07:52 PM PHT

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Free IDEs

Open-source programming languages

Generative AI (use with discretion)

What tools do we have?

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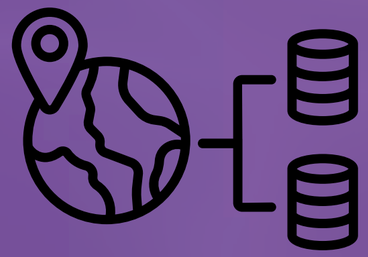
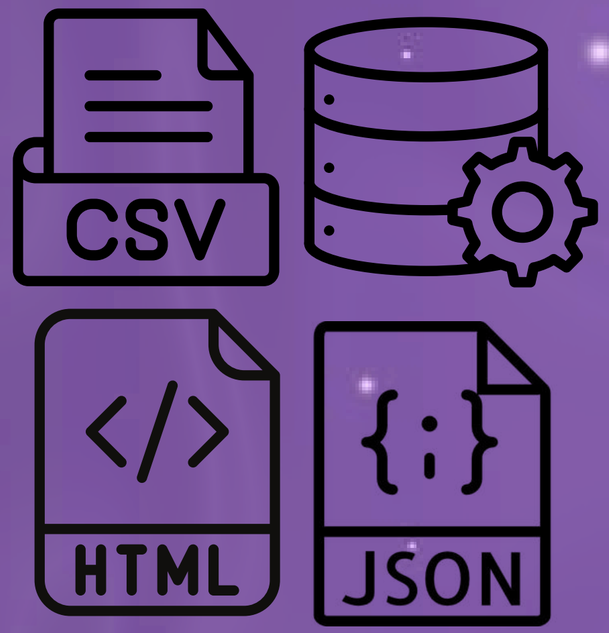
Unstructured Data

Both



Structured Data



What data do we have?

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Better GovPH

open source initiative®

It’s time for data science and AI to be used for social good.

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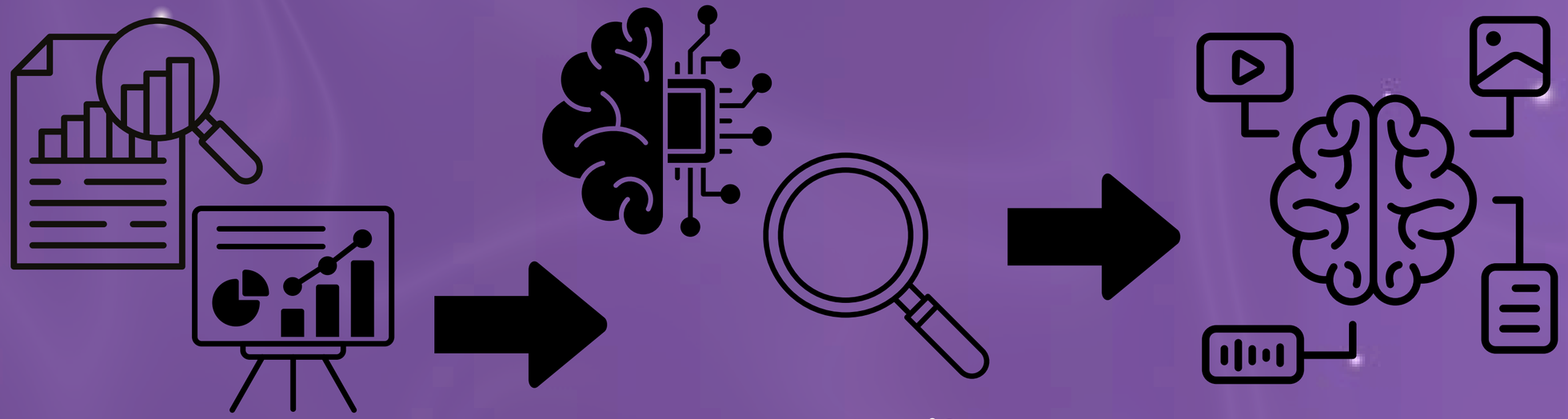

Start with EDA w/ Data Viz

Detect or classify anomalies w/ classical ML

(Try to) Scale and do more with GenAI

Roadmap in starting DS/AI projects

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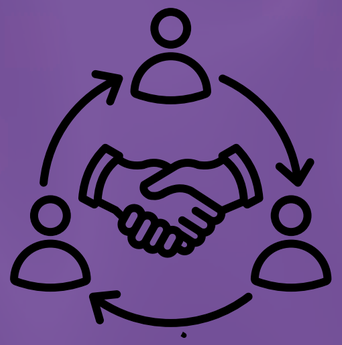
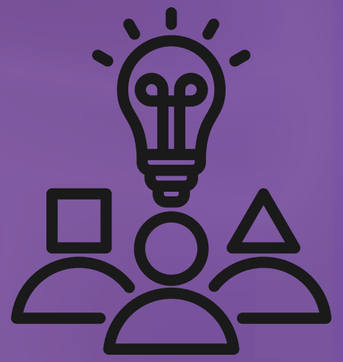
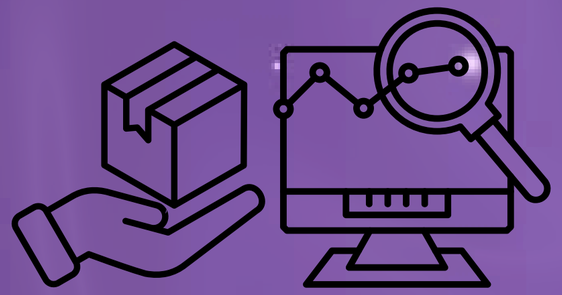


Join orgs or form your own

Work individually or by group



Join workshops and hackathons



Develop a product and/or do research

How to organize?

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Augmenting AI: RAG and Agentic Approaches

Retrieval augmented generation (RAG) is a method of adding a **vector database** which could be attached to genAI pipelines in order to produce more accurate, up-to-date, and context-specific responses.

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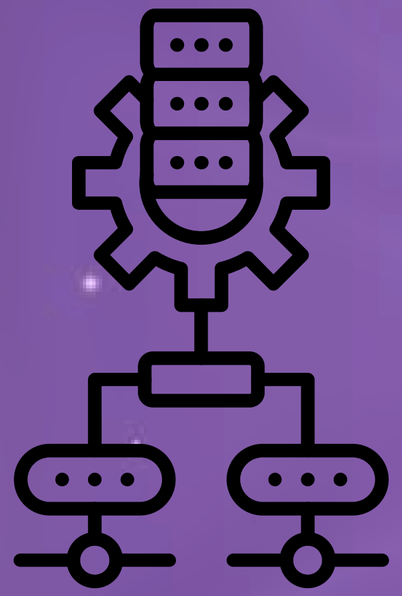
Augmenting AI: RAG and Agentic Approaches

Agentic AI is a design principle for building AI systems composed of interconnected components that work together autonomously, pursue defined goals, and make decisions or take actions in multi-step workflows without constant human prompting.



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- Convert datasets into a publicly accessible vector database for semantic querying of government spending, legislation, and procurement records.
- Build a unified vector-indexed archive of news articles to enable semantic search across journalistic content, beyond simple keyword matching.
- **Use the vector databases as the backend for AI-driven civic-tech tools.**

Project Ideas

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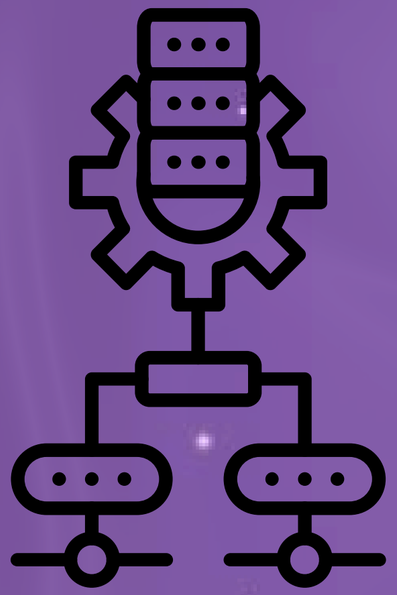
- Build a **fact-checking AI agent** that automatically retrieves relevant sources, verifies claims, and outputs evidence-backed verdicts.
- Develop an AI-agent that monitors incoming public-data feeds and news, such as anomalous contracts, potential corruption signals, emerging misinformation, alerting civic-society groups.



Project Ideas

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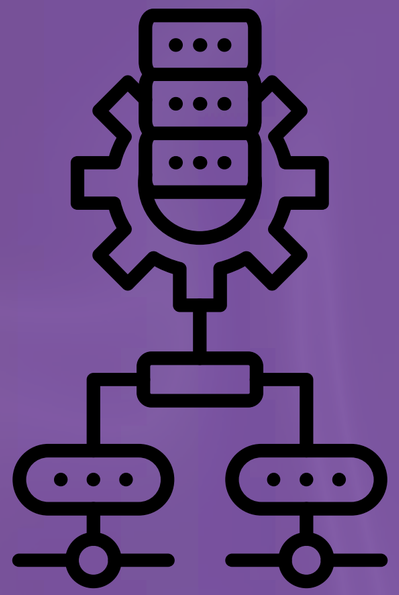

Build an agentic system that **geolocates properties of high-ranking public officials**: to expose hidden patterns of wealth, land ownership, and potential corruption.

Project Ideas

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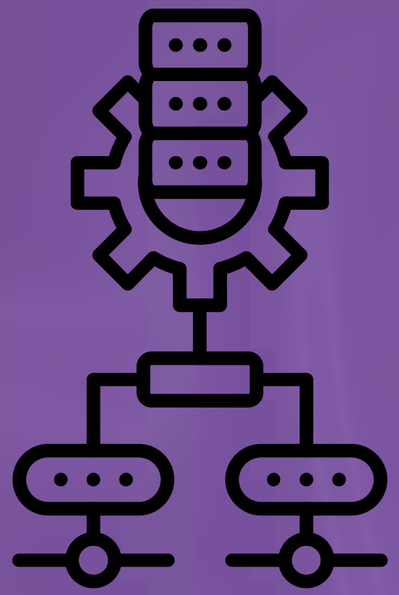

Create a **network-analysis and entity-mapping AI pipeline** that automatically reconstructs complex relationships among public officials, contractors, companies, properties, and transactions

Project Ideas

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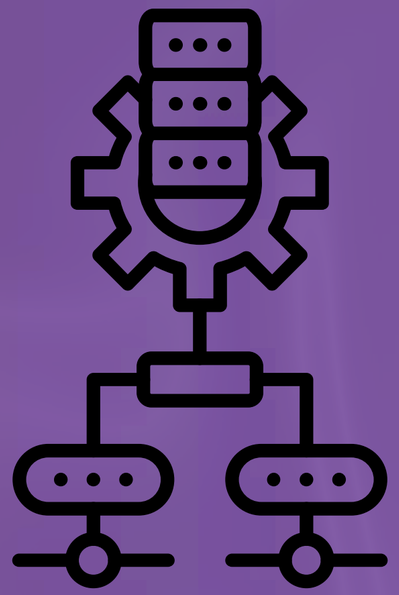

Build an AI system that **detects troll accounts**, then attempts to infer identity attributes for possible doxxing.

Project Ideas

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Use data science and AI to serve the people!

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THANK YOU!

Open for questions.